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PREMIUM NOTES

UPSC — All Subjects Notes (Complete Bundle)

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UPSC — History Notes

Ancient — Concepts UPSC Tests

- Neolithic: first food producers; Burzahom (Kashmir — pit dwellings), Chirand (Bihar — bone tools). Chalcolithic cultures: Ahar (Rajasthan), Jorwe (Maharashtra), Kayatha (MP).
- Harappan: town planning (grid, drainage, burnt bricks 1:2:4 ratio), weights in binary/decimal multiples, script undeciphered (pictographic, right-to-left boustrophedon), no temples identified; Priest-King (steatite), Dancing Girl (bronze, lost-wax), Great Bath (ritual bathing). Cotton was first produced here (Greek 'Sindon').
- Later Vedic: iron (krishna ayas), PGW culture, first territorial states (janapadas → 16 Mahajanapadas; capitals: Magadha—Rajgriha/Pataliputra, Kosala—Shravasti, Vatsa—Kaushambi, Avanti—Ujjain). Ajatashatru built Pataliputra fort; Bimbisara (Haryanka) contemporary of Buddha & Mahavira.
- Ashokan edicts: Major Rock Edict XIII (Kalinga + dhamma), Pillars (polished sandstone, Lauriya Nandangarh lion), Rummindei pillar (Lumbini, tax reduced to 1/8). Scripts: Brahmi (left→right), Kharoshthi (right→left, NW), Greek/Aramaic in Afghanistan.
- Post-Mauryan: Indo-Greeks (Menander/Milinda — Milindapanho), Shakas (Rudradaman — Junagadh inscription, first long Sanskrit inscription; Sudarshana lake repairs), Kushanas (Kanishka — 78 CE Shaka era, 4th Buddhist council, Gandhara & Mathura art, silk route). Satavahanas (first land grants to Brahmanas — epigraphic evidence; lead coins, Amaravati art).
- Gupta & after: land grant economy debate (feudalism — R.S. Sharma), temple architecture begins (Dashavatara Deogarh), zero & decimal (Aryabhata), court poet Harisena. Sangam literature: Tolkappiyam (grammar), Silappadikaram (Ilango Adigal), Manimekalai; three Sangams at Madurai; Chera (bow), Chola (tiger), Pandya (fish) emblems.

Medieval — State, Economy, Culture

- Delhi Sultanate administration: Iqta system (revenue assignment, systematised by Iltutmish, reformed by Balban/Alauddin), Khalisa (crown land), Diwan-i-Arz (military, Alauddin), token currency experiment (MBT, 1329–30, failed), Daulatabad shift (1327).
- Bhakti regional forms: Maharashtra (Varkari — Jnaneshwar, Namdev, Tukaram; Pandharpur), Assam (Ekasharana — Srimanta Sankardeva), Bengal (Chaitanya — Gaudiya Vaishnavism), Karnataka (Virashaiva/Lingayat — Basava, Vachana literature). Alvars (Vaishnava) & Nayanars (Shaiva) — Tamil bhakti, 6th–9th c.
- Mughal systems: Mansabdari (zat = personal rank/pay; sawar = cavalry contingent), Zabt (measurement-based revenue — Todar Mal, Ain-i-Dahsala), Jagir (transferable) vs Inam; Ain-i-Akbari by Abul Fazl (Akbar Nama 3rd part). Painting: Humayun brought Persian masters; Jahangir era naturalism peak (Ustad Mansur).
- Architecture lines: Qutub complex (Delhi), Alai Darwaza (first true dome/arch — Alauddin), Tughlaqabad (massive sloping walls), Sher Shah's tomb (Sasaram, lake), Fatehpur Sikri (Buland Darwaza), Itimad-ud-Daulah (first pietra dura, all-marble — Jahangir era), Taj (1632–53, Ustad Ahmad Lahauri tradition).
- Vijayanagara: four dynasties (Sangama, Saluva, Tuluva, Aravidu); Krishnadeva Raya's Amuktamalyada (Telugu); Hazara Rama & Vittala temples (musical pillars); foreign travellers — Nicolo Conti, Abdur Razzaq, Domingo Paes, Nuniz.

Modern — Movements & Constitutional Development

- Peasant/tribal movements: Indigo (1859–60 Bengal), Pabna (1873), Deccan Riots (1875), Champaran/Kheda, Bardoli (1928 — Patel got 'Sardar'), Tebhaga (1946 Bengal), Telangana (1946–51). Tribal: Santhal Hul (1855 — Sidhu-Kanhu), Munda Ulgulan (1899–1900 — Birsa), Kol (1831), Rampa (1922 — Alluri Sitarama Raju).
- Press & education: first newspaper Bengal Gazette (1780, Hicky); Vernacular Press Act 1878 (Lytton, repealed by Ripon); Wood's Despatch 1854 ('Magna Carta of English education'); Hunter Commission 1882; Universities 1857 (Calcutta, Bombay, Madras).
- Constitutional acts ladder: 1773 (GG of Bengal, SC at Calcutta) → 1784 Pitt's (dual control) → 1813 (trade monopoly ends, ₹1 lakh education) → 1833 (GG of India — Bentinck first; law commission — Macaulay) → 1853 (open competition principle) → 1858 (Crown rule, Secretary of State) → 1861 (portfolio system begins) → 1892 (indirect election element) → 1909 (separate electorates) → 1919 (dyarchy in provinces, bicameral centre) → 1935 (provincial autonomy, dyarchy at centre proposed, RBI & Federal Court under it).
- Partition & transfer: Wavell Plan & Simla Conference 1945; Cabinet Mission 1946 (grouping scheme); Interim Government (Nehru as VP, Sept 1946); Mountbatten Plan (3 June 1947); Radcliffe Award (boundaries); integration of princely states — Patel + V.P. Menon; holdouts: Junagadh (plebiscite), Hyderabad (Operation Polo, Sept 1948), Kashmir (accession 26 Oct 1947).
- Post-1947 integration: States Reorganisation — Fazl Ali Commission; SRC Act 1956 (14 states, 6 UTs); first linguistic state Andhra (1953, after Potti Sriramulu). Goa liberated 1961 (Operation Vijay); Sikkim 1975 (36th Amd — full state).

UPSC — Geography Notes

Physical Geography — Processes

- Plate tectonics: Himalaya = continent–continent convergence (Indian plate moving NE ~5 cm/yr); earthquakes concentrated along plate boundaries; Wadati–Benioff zone = subduction seismic belt.
- Rocks: Igneous (primary — basalt Deccan traps from fissure eruptions ~66 mya), Sedimentary (stratified, fossils), Metamorphic (marble from limestone, gneiss from granite, schist). Rock cycle links all three.
- Landforms: river stages — youthful (V-valley, rapids, waterfalls), mature (meanders), old (oxbow lakes, deltas). Karst (limestone — caves, sinkholes — Meghalaya caves). Aeolian: barchans (crescent dunes), loess. Glacial: moraines, drumlins, U-valleys, fjords.
- Atmosphere: layers — Troposphere (weather, lapse rate 6.5°C/km), Stratosphere (ozone), Mesosphere (meteors burn), Thermosphere/Ionosphere (radio reflection), Exosphere. Jet streams: sub-tropical westerly (drives western disturbances), tropical easterly (monsoon link).
- Ocean: salinity highest in Dead Sea/lake Van; currents — warm (Kuroshio, Gulf Stream) vs cold (Oyashio, Labrador, Benguela, Humboldt/Peru — Atacama dryness); El Niño = warm water off Peru coast; tides = moon > sun gravity (spring/neap).

Indian Geography — Systems

- Drainage patterns: dendritic (plains), trellis (folded — old Himalaya streams), radial (Amarkantak), antecedent rivers (Indus, Sutlej, Brahmaputra — older than Himalaya, cut gorges).
- Monsoon mechanics: ITCZ shift, Tibetan plateau heating (thermal low), Somali jet, Mascarene high, ENSO & IOD (Indian Ocean Dipole — positive IOD can offset weak El Niño years). Break monsoon = rain shifts to Himalayan foothills/Brahmaputra.

- Soil orders (ICAR 8): Alluvial, Black, Red, Laterite, Arid, Forest/Mountain, Peaty/Marshy, Saline/Alkaline. Soil health: NPK ideal ratio 4:2:1 (India skewed towards N — urea subsidy effect).
- Natural vegetation: Tropical evergreen (>200 cm rain — Western Ghats, NE — ebony, mahogany, rosewood), moist deciduous (100–200 cm — teak, sal), dry deciduous (70–100 cm — tendu), thorn (<50 cm — acacia), montane, mangrove (Sundarbans largest — Sundari tree; Bhitarkanika second).
- Resources & industry location: coal (Jharia richest, Raniganj oldest), iron ore (Odisha–Chhattisgarh–Karnataka belt; Bailadila high grade), bauxite (Odisha top), mica (Koderma). Steel plants & their logic: Bhilai (Russian collab), Rourkela (German), Durgapur (British), Bokaro (Russian) — near coal/iron + water + rail.

Environment & Ecology

- Biodiversity: India = 4 of 36 global hotspots (Himalaya, Indo-Burma, Western Ghats–Sri Lanka, Sundaland). Levels: genetic, species, ecosystem. Alpha (within habitat), Beta (between), Gamma (regional) diversity.
- Protected areas hierarchy: National Park (107) > Sanctuary (573) > Conservation/Community Reserves; Biosphere Reserves (18 — Nilgiri first 1986; 12 in UNESCO MAB); Tiger Reserves (Project Tiger 1973 — NTCA statutory under WLPA amendment 2006; Corbett first NP 1936).
- Conventions: Ramsar (1971, wetlands — India 90+ sites, TN highest), CITES (trade in species), CBD (1992 — Nagoya Protocol ABS, Aichi/Kunming-Montreal targets 30×30), UNFCCC (1992) → Kyoto (1997, binding developed) → Paris (2015, NDCs; India: net zero 2070, 50% non-fossil capacity by 2030), Stockholm (POPs), Basel (hazardous waste), Minamata (mercury).
- Species files: Bengal tiger (apex, umbrella), Asiatic lion (Gir only — population rising, Barda proposed second home), Great Indian Bustard (Critically Endangered — Rajasthan state bird), Gangetic dolphin (National Aquatic Animal), Olive Ridley (Gahirmatha mass nesting — arribada), Red Panda (Eastern Himalaya), Hangul (Kashmir stag — Dachigam).
- Pollution & health: AQI categories (0–500; PM2.5/PM10, NO_2, SO_2, CO, O_3, NH_3, Pb); stubble burning (PUSA decomposer), Bharat Stage VI (2020), NCAP (2019). Waste rules: e-waste, plastic (single-use ban 2022), solid waste 2016.

Mapping — PYQ Locations

- Straits: Malacca (Malaysia–Indonesia), Hormuz (oil chokepoint — Iran/Oman), Bab-el-Mandeb (Red Sea–Gulf of Aden), Bering (Russia–Alaska), Gibraltar, Taiwan, Mozambique Channel.
- Conflict/news regions: Gaza Strip, West Bank, Golan Heights, Donbas, South China Sea (nine-dash line), Senkaku/Diaoyu, Kuril Islands, Nagorno-Karabakh.
- Indian mapping: Siliguri Corridor ('Chicken's Neck'), Doklam (Bhutan–China–India trijunction), Galwan (Ladakh, LAC), Sir Creek (Gujarat–Sindh dispute), Kalapani–Lipulek (Nepal), Katchatheevu (Sri Lanka).

UPSC — Polity Notes

Constitutional Framework — Deeper Map

- Basic structure (Kesavananda 1973): Parliament can amend (Art 368) but cannot destroy the basic structure — supremacy of Constitution, republic/democratic form, secularism, separation of powers, federal character, judicial review (Minerva Mills reaffirmed).

- Citizenship: Part II (Art 5–11); Citizenship Act 1955 — by birth, descent, registration, naturalisation, territory incorporation; CAA 2019 (religion-based fast-track for 6 communities from Pakistan/Bangladesh/Afghanistan, cut-off 31 Dec 2014). Single citizenship (unlike USA). OCI ≠ dual citizenship.
- Territory: Art 1 (Union of States — 'Union' because indestructible union of destructible states), Art 2 (admit/establish new states), Art 3 (Parliament can alter area/name/boundaries — state legislature's views not binding; presidential recommendation + reference to legislature needed).
- Judicial doctrines: eclipse (pre-constitutional laws), severability, waiver (not allowed for FRs), territorial nexus, pith & substance, colourable legislation, harmonious construction.

Rights, Duties, Principles

- Art 19 freedoms: speech & expression, assemble peacefully WITHOUT ARMS, form associations/unions, move freely, reside & settle, practise profession/trade. Restrictions: Art 19(2)–(6) grounds — 'reasonable restrictions'; internet shutdowns tested on proportionality (Anuradha Bhasin).
- Art 21 expansion: privacy (Puttaswamy 2017 — fundamental right), clean environment, livelihood, speedy trial, education (before 21A — Unnikrishnan), choice of partner (Shafin Jahan), die with dignity/passive euthanasia (Common Cause 2018).
- DPSPs: Art 38 (welfare state), 39 (resource distribution), 39A (free legal aid), 40 (village panchayats), 41–43 (work, living wage, cottage industries), 43B (co-operatives — 97th Amd), 44 (UCC), 45 (early childhood care), 47 (health, prohibition), 48 (agriculture/animal husbandry), 48A (environment), 49 (monuments), 50 (separation of judiciary), 51 (international peace).
- Fundamental Duties (51A): added by 42nd Amd 1976 on Swaran Singh Committee (originally 10; 11th added by 86th Amd — parent's duty to provide education opportunities to child 6–14). Non-justiciable; borrowed from USSR.

Institutions & Processes

- Parliamentary devices: Question Hour (first hour; starred/unstarred/short notice), Zero Hour (Indian innovation, 1962), motions — adjournment, censure (against government), no-confidence (LS only, Art 75 collective responsibility), cut motions (policy, economy, token).
- Committees: PAC (22 members — 15 LS + 7 RS; chair from opposition by convention; examines CAG reports), Estimates (30, LS only), Public Undertakings (22), Departmentally Related Standing Committees (24 — 31 members each), Ethics, Privileges. Joint Parliamentary Committee = ad hoc.
- Budget process: Art 112 (Annual Financial Statement), Consolidated Fund (Art 266 — charged + voted), Contingency Fund (267), Public Account (266(2)); demands for grants — only LS votes; Appropriation Bill; Finance Bill; FRBM Act 2003 (fiscal deficit targets). Railway budget merged 2017; budget date advanced to 1 Feb (2017).
- Federal features vs unitary tilt: dual polity, written constitution, division of powers (7th Schedule — Union 100, State 61, Concurrent 52 entries approx.), independent judiciary vs single citizenship, All-India Services, emergency converting to unitary, integrated judiciary, Governor's office.
- Election Commission: Art 324; CEC removal like SC judge; others on CEC recommendation; Model Code (not statutory — consensus evolved); EVM-VVPAT (100% VVPAT slips, counting mandated for 5 random booths per segment — SC ruling); NOTA (PUCL 2013).

Local Governance & Recent Themes

- Panchayat finance: own revenue is tiny — dependence on Finance Commission grants (15th FC: ₹2.36 lakh crore to RLBs 2021–26, tied/untied 40:60 pattern); SFC recommendations (Art 243I/243Y). PESA 1996 (Scheduled Areas — Gram Sabha powers over land/resources).
- Urban bodies: 74th Amd types; District Planning Committee (243ZD), Metropolitan Planning Committee (243ZE); municipal bonds; AMRUT, Smart Cities Mission, SBM-Urban.
- Tribunals: Art 323A (administrative — CAT/SAT) & 323B (other matters); NGT Act 2010 (benches — principal New Delhi); appellate tribunal rationalisation debates; tribunal independence (Madras Bar Association cases).
- Anti-defection: 10th Schedule (52nd Amd 1985); disqualification decided by Speaker/Chairman (reviewable — Kihoto Hollohan); 91st Amd capped ministry size + barred defectors from ministerial office until re-election; split exception (2/3 merger) remains, 1/3 split removed.

UPSC — Economy Notes

National Income & Macro Basics

- GDP (market price) vs GNP: GNP = GDP + net factor income from abroad. NNP at factor cost = National Income. Base year currently 2011–12 (revision ongoing). GDP deflator = nominal/real × 100 (broadest inflation measure — all goods).
- GVA vs GDP: GDP = GVA + net product taxes. Sectors' GVA share (recent): services ~55%, industry ~28%, agriculture ~18% (but ~46% employment — the core structural imbalance).
- Fiscal terms: Revenue deficit, Effective revenue deficit, Fiscal deficit = total expenditure − (revenue receipts + non-debt capital receipts); Primary deficit = fiscal deficit − interest payments. Centre's fiscal deficit target path (FRBM glide): 4.5% of GDP by 2025–26 benchmark era.
- Monetary policy: MPC (6 members, 3 RBI + 3 govt; RBI Governor casting vote); inflation target 4% ± 2% (CPI combined, flexible inflation targeting since 2016); instruments — repo, reverse repo, SDF (standing deposit facility, floor), MSF (ceiling), CRR, SLR, OMO.

Banking, Money & Markets

- RBI functions: note issue (₹2+; ₹1 & coins — Ministry of Finance), banker to government & banks, lender of last resort, forex custodian (FERA→FEMA 1999). NPA terms: SMA (0/1/2), NPA = 90 days overdue; SARFAESI 2002; IBC 2016 (CIRP 330-day outer limit).
- Priority sector lending: 40% of ANBC for domestic banks (agriculture 18%, micro-enterprises 7.5%, weaker sections 12%). PSL certificates tradable.
- Payments/fintech: UPI (NPCI — also runs RuPay, IMPS, NACH), CBDC (e₹ — pilot retail & wholesale 2022), Account Aggregator framework, ONDC (open network for e-commerce).
- Markets: SEBI (1988/1992), primary vs secondary market, Sensex (30, BSE, base 1978–79=100), NIFTY (50, NSE, base 1995=1000), G-Secs, T-Bills (91/182/364 days), Call money (overnight).

External Sector & Trade

- BoP: Current account (trade + invisibles — services & remittances) + Capital account (FDI, FPI, loans, banking capital). CAD financed by capital inflows/forex reserves. India's forex = foreign currency assets + gold + SDR + IMF reserve tranche (RBI custodian).

- FDI vs FPI: FDI = lasting interest (≥10% voting typically), FPI = portfolio ('hot money'). Top FDI sources (recent): Singapore, Mauritius, USA. Sectors: services, computer software/hardware, trading.
- Trade pattern: largest merchandise deficit with China; top export items — engineering goods, petroleum products, gems & jewellery, pharma, electronics (rising). Remittances: India world No. 1 (~$125 bn+ recent year, UAE/USA top sources).
- Institutions: WTO (1995, Geneva — MFN, national treatment; Appellate Body non-functional since 2019), IMF (quota/SDR), World Bank Group (IBRD, IDA, IFC, MIGA, ICSID — India not in ICSID), ADB (Manila), AIIB (Beijing), NDB (BRICS, Shanghai).

Schemes, Reports & Indices

- Flagship items: PM-KISAN (₹6,000/yr, 3 instalments), Ayushman Bharat PM-JAY (₹5 lakh/family/yr, world's largest assurance scheme), PM Awas Yojana, Jal Jeevan Mission (Har Ghar Jal — 55 lpcd), PM-JDY (Jan Dhan — JAM trinity), MGNREGA (100 days, demand-driven, legal right), PM Mudra (loans up to ₹10 lakh; 'Tarun Plus' ₹20 lakh in Budget 2024).
- Reports/indexes: HDI (UNDP — India in medium category), Global Hunger Index (IFPRI/concern — methodology contested by GoI), Ease of Doing Business (discontinued 2021), Logistics Performance Index (World Bank), Global Innovation Index (WIPO — India top-40), SDG India Index (NITI Aayog).
- Committees: Urjit Patel (monetary policy framework), Bimal Jalan (economic capital framework/RBI surplus), Kelkar (tax/PPP), Rangarajan (poverty line), Tendulkar (poverty), P.J. Nayak (bank governance).

UPSC — Environment & Ecology Notes

Ecology Fundamentals

- Ecosystem services (Millennium Assessment): provisioning, regulating, supporting, cultural. Ecological pyramid — energy pyramid is ALWAYS upright (10% law — Lindeman); number/biomass can invert (ocean biomass).
- Biogeochemical cycles: Carbon (photosynthesis/respiration), Nitrogen (fixation — Rhizobium, lightning; nitrification; denitrification), Phosphorus (no atmospheric phase — sedimentary, slowest), Sulphur, Water.
- Adaptations & interactions: mutualism (lichen — algae+fungi), commensalism (orchid on tree), parasitism, predation, competition; ecotone = transition zone (edge effect); ecological niche vs habitat.
- Succession: pioneer → climax; xerarch (rock), hydrarch (water); primary vs secondary (faster — soil exists). Invasive species in India: Lantana, Prosopis juliflora, water hyacinth (Eichhornia — 'terror of Bengal'), Parthenium.

Climate Change Architecture

- UNFCCC (1992 Rio) — principles: CBDR-RC; Kyoto (1997 — Annex I binding, CDM/JI/emissions trading); Paris (2015 — NDCs, 2°C/well below + 1.5°C pursuit, global stocktake every 5 yrs, ratchet mechanism).
- India's updated NDC: 45% emissions-intensity reduction by 2030 (from 2005), 50% cumulative electric installed capacity from non-fossil by 2030, net zero 2070 (announced COP26 Glasgow — Panchamrit: 500 GW non-fossil by 2030, one billion tonne reduction etc.).
- IPCC AR6 key lines: human-caused warming unequivocal; every increment worsens extremes; remaining carbon budget for 1.5°C shrinking. GHG inventory gases basket: CO_2, CH_4, N_2O,

HFCs, PFCs, SF_6, NF_3.

- India bodies/schemes: NAPCC (2008 — 8 missions: solar, energy efficiency, water, Himalayan ecosystem, green India, sustainable habitat, agriculture, strategic knowledge), National Green Hydrogen Mission (2023), LiFE (Lifestyle for Environment — COP26 concept), International Solar Alliance (2015, HQ Gurugram — first treaty-based org headquartered in India).

Biodiversity Governance

- Biological Diversity Act 2002: NBA (Chennai) — approval for foreign access; State Biodiversity Boards; Biodiversity Management Committees (local — People's Biodiversity Registers). 2023 amendment: decriminalised offences, AYUSH exemptions debate.
- Wildlife Protection Act 1972: schedules rationalised by 2022 amendment (4 schedules now); CITES-aligned; NBWL chaired by PM; State Board by CM. Forest Conservation Act 1980 (post-2023: Van (Sanrakshan Evam Samvardhan) Adhiniyam — applicability clarifications for recorded forest areas).
- Forest cover data (ISFR — FSI, biennial): India forest+tree cover ~25% of geographical area (target 33% — National Forest Policy 1988); largest forest cover state — MP (area), highest % — Mizoram; mangrove cover ~5,000 km^2 (Sundarbans largest share). Assessment uses canopy density classes (VDF/MDF/OF).
- Keystone & indicator examples: tiger/sea otter (keystone), lichens (air pollution indicators — SO_2 sensitive), frogs (ecosystem health), vultures collapse (diclofenac — livestock drug; vulture restaurants & Jatayu centres as response).

Pollution, Waste & Energy Transition

- Air: primary pollutants (CO, SO_2, NOx, PM) vs secondary (ozone, PAN — photochemical smog). SAFAR/NAQI monitoring; GRAP (Graded Response Action Plan — Delhi NCR, CAQM statutory 2021).
- Water: BOD (biochemical oxygen demand — higher = more polluted), COD; dissolved oxygen sag; thermal pollution; groundwater contamination (arsenic — Bengal basin, fluoride — Rajasthan belt, nitrate — fertiliser overuse). CPCB/SPCB under Water Act 1974, Air Act 1981, EPA 1986 (umbrella — post Bhopal).
- EIA Notification 2006 (under EPA): Category A (central) / B (state); public hearing; TOR → EIA report → appraisal (EAC/SEAC) → clearance with conditions; draft EIA 2020 controversies (post-facto clearance, public consultation cuts).
- Energy mix targets: 500 GW non-fossil capacity by 2030; solar largest share; green hydrogen (electrolysers — renewable), ethanol blending E20 target (advanced to 2025–26), SATAT (CBG), PM-KUSUM (solar pumps), National Biofuel Policy. Battery/swapping & FAME→PM E-DRIVE transitions for EVs.

Current Affairs Digest — 2026 Mega Events (StuDy CA Notes)

How to Use This Note

- These notes collect the VERIFIED big-ticket facts of 2026 that SSC/RPSC/UPSC papers love: mega sports events (medal tables, hosts, superlatives) — the section where papers plant their famous near-miss traps.
- StuDy refreshes the Current Affairs question pool every 2–3 days in the app. These notes are updated on request — always check the latest in-app CA tests for fresh items.

ICC T20 World Cup 2026 (India & Sri Lanka)

- Champions: INDIA — beat New Zealand by 96 runs in the final at Ahmedabad.
- India's 3rd T20 World Cup title (2007, 2024, 2026) — first team to DEFEND the title and first HOST to win it.
- Player of the Tournament: Sanju Samson. Player of the Final: Jasprit Bumrah (4/15).
- Most runs in the tournament: Sahibzada Farhan (Pakistan) — 383 runs. (Tournament topper ≠ winning team's player — classic trap.)

FIFA World Cup 2026 (USA · Canada · Mexico)

- Champions: SPAIN — beat Argentina 1–0 in the final; Ferran Torres scored the extra-time winner (106').
- Spain's 2nd World Cup title (first: 2010). First 48-team World Cup in history.
- Golden Ball (best player): Rodri. Golden Boot (top scorer): Kylian Mbappé — 10 goals. England finished 3rd.
- Trap radar: Player of the Final ≠ Player of the Tournament in reports — always read the exact wording of the question.

Commonwealth Games 2026 (Glasgow)

- India finished 4th with 39 medals (13 Gold, 17 Silver, 9 Bronze). Australia topped the table (171 medals).
- A trimmed-down Games: only 10 sports. Boxing was India's best sport — 10 medals including 7 golds.
- Next Commonwealth Games: Ahmedabad 2030 (India hosts).

Asian Games 2026 (Aichi–Nagoya, Japan)

- India finished 4th with 85 medals (21 Gold, 27 Silver, 37 Bronze). China topped (341), Japan 2nd, Korea 3rd.
- Archery gave India the most golds (5). Athletics gave the most medals overall (24) but only 1 gold.
- Kumkum Mohod (17) — first Indian woman to win an individual recurve gold at the Asian Games.
- Next Asian Games: Doha 2030. (Nagoya 2026 vs Doha 2030 is a designed trap — do not swap.)

Trap Radar — Current Affairs

- Most medals ≠ most golds; Player of the Final ≠ Player of the Tournament; host year pairs (2026 vs 2030) are the examiner's favourite swap.
- First ≠ first Indian (e.g., first Governor-General of independent India — Mountbatten; first INDIAN Governor-General — Rajagopalachari).
- Read the question's exact noun: 'host', 'winner', 'top scorer', 'best player' are four different answers in the same event.

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